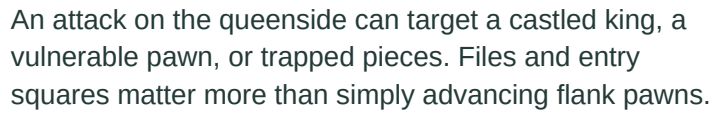


Queenside attacks

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES



Locate the critical target and which pawn or piece move opens a route toward it. Check whether central counterplay interrupts the plan.

The defending king is on c8. Geometrically undefended: rook on h8. Check for tactical protection.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

33.Ra8+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. Recorded reply: **33...Rb8**.

34.Rxb8+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the rook on b8. Recorded reply: **34...Qxb8**.

35.Qd7# Mate: queen on d7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on c8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on d7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

The board's left half is not inherently safe. Queen checks and rook entries can make a queenside king as vulnerable as a kingside one.